MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with experience owning CI/CD pipelines and building test infrastructure for three product teams. Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and improved end-to-end test reliability from a 7% flaky rate to below 1%. Hands-on with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments, with additional personal experience operating a k3s GitOps homelab and provisioning a Hetzner VPS with Terraform. Seeking a move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure: Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access and test-environment deployments), k3s, Terraform (personal project)
Monitoring and TLS: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, cert-manager, TLS certificate management
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 fundamentals (personal learning)
Programming and data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Linux, Git, Ansible (basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021 - Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments for the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed via Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI; environments are removed automatically after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests; reduced monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Python and Bash tooling for test-data seeding; collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards to track flaky tests.
- Wrote internal documentation on how CI works, used in onboarding, and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019 - 2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal project | 2024 - 2025

- Ran a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS; provisioned a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform and used Ansible (basic).

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Preparing for Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA); exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet passed).

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)